

# Privilege Escalation Techniques

## CompTIA PenTest+ (PT0-003)

### Domains:

- 4.0: Attacks and Exploits
- 5.0: Post-exploitation and Lateral Movement

### Objectives:

- 4.4: Given a scenario, perform host-based attacks using the appropriate tools.
- 5.1: Given a scenario, perform tasks to establish and maintain persistence.
- 5.2: Given a scenario, perform tasks to move laterally throughout the environment.

## Video Overview

This video will introduce you to privilege escalation, a fundamental concept in cybersecurity and penetration testing. You will learn about different types of privilege escalation, including horizontal and vertical approaches, and explore cross-platform techniques that apply to both Windows and Linux systems. We will also delve into specific vulnerabilities and tools used in each environment, preparing you to understand how attackers gain higher levels of access and how these methods relate to real-world security challenges. This knowledge is directly applicable to the PenTest+ certification exam, helping you develop a practical understanding of host-based attacks and lateral movement.

## Key Topics Covered

- Types of Privilege Escalation: Horizontal vs. Vertical
- Cross-Platform Techniques: Password Reuse, Misconfigured Permissions, Scheduled Tasks (Cron Jobs), Kernel Exploits, Unpatched/Outdated Software
- Windows-Specific Techniques: Unquoted Service Paths, DLL Hijacking, Unattended/Uninstall Files, Registry Hacks
- Linux-Specific Techniques: SUID/GUID Binaries, Sudo Abuse
- Lateral Movement Tools and Techniques: Mimikatz, BloodHound, Pass-the-Hash (PtH), Pass-the-Ticket (PtT)

## Student Notes Section